ZIHAO LI

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MiShenng | Zihao Li

EDUCATION

- **Lanzhou University** Sep. 2023 - Jun. 2027
  B.A. in Journalism *Lanzhou*
  - **Relevant Coursework:** New Media User Analysis (95), Media Criticism (95), Research Methods in Communication Studies (95), Data Journalism (95), Public Opinion (94), Introduction to Communication (95), Communication Psychology (91)
  - **GPA:** 4.07/5
- **National Taiwan Normal University** Aug. 2025 - Dec. 2025
  Exchange Student *Taipei*
  - **Relevant Coursework:** New Media and Society Seminar (A), Research Method of Social Science (A), Visual Culture and Communication (A-)
  - **GPA:** 3.9/4.0

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCE PAPERS

Should I Stay Calm? Visual and Textual Frames and Anger in Short-Video Comments

Zihao Li.* *AEJMC* 2026 [🌐]

- Developed an AI-agent-based approach to automate the analysis of visual and textual affective frames in short videos. Used machine learning to measure anger in audience comments and examined associations between multimodal frame combinations and anger around a controversial Chinese policy.
- Found that visual and textual frames tended to align and were independently associated with audience anger. A two-way ANOVA showed significant main effects for both modalities but no significant interaction.

Generation, Negotiation, and Connection: Participatory Curation and Platformized Urban Digital Memory

M. Xiao, R. Zhao, & **Zihao Li**.* *Chinese Platform Studies Academic Workshop* 2026

- Conducted computational analysis for a study of urban digital memory on Douyin. Collected and preprocessed video and comment data, developed a customized local place-name dictionary, and applied BERTopic, NMF, and topic similarity analysis to identify recurring discourse topics and examine semantic relationships.
- Drawing on Hoskins' connective memory theory, the study shows how participatory interactions transform personal memories into shared urban narratives, while visual content connects users across generations and regions.

WORKING PAPERS

Moral Cues in Visual Misinformation: Visual Event Schemas and the Moral Reorientation of Authentic Images

Xinxin Li, & **Zihao Li**.* Manuscript in Preparation [🌐]

- Combined Moral Foundations Theory with visual event schemas to examine how false captions reconstruct the moral meanings of authentic images in cheap fakes, providing a framework for understanding image–text interactions in multimodal misinformation.
- Contributed to research design, data collection, analysis, and manuscript writing. Paired false claims with the original contexts of corresponding images, extracted variables using computer vision, and conducted latent class analysis and linear regression.

From Emotion to Hostility: Discrete Emotions and Gender-Directed Incivility in Chinese Gender-Issue Videos

Zihao Li.* Under Review, *ICA* 2027 [🌐]

- Studied gender-related discussions on Douyin using a multimodal emotion model to measure discrete negative emotions as predictors. Coded video topics and narrative techniques as moderators using a large vision model. Developed a supervised classifier to identify incivility and toxic comments targeting women and men. Applied binomial regression and interaction tests to examine emotion–incivility associations.
- Found that anger was positively associated with incivility and fear negatively associated, with both associations moderated by video topics and selected narrative techniques. Across all topics, toxic comments targeting women outnumbered those targeting men.

See It, Click It? Visual Clickbait and Stratified Engagement in Bilibili Health Videos

Zihao Li.* Under Review, *ICA* 2027 [🌐]

- Examined visual clickbait in health-related Bilibili videos using computational methods. Collected thumbnails and engagement data, using LLM-assisted coding and Chinese-CLIP to measure visual cues and thumbnail–title congruence. Applied negative binomial regression to examine engagement outcomes.
- Found that binary clickbait measures may obscure differences among visual strategies. Clickbait was positively associated with views; after adjusting for view counts, it was negatively associated with likes, coins, favorites, and shares, highlighting differences between attention and deeper engagement.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Discourse Construction and Visual Narratives in Converged Media

Research Assistant | PI: Xinxin Li, Lanzhou University Dec. 2024 - Apr. 2025 [🌐]

- Built a dataset of *People's Daily* environmental reporting from 1949 to the present and developed an LLM-based automated coding pipeline. Using Fairclough's discourse analysis framework and the history of China's environmental policies, identified distinct phases of environmental discourse and developed the findings into a research paper.
- Developed a web crawler to collect environmental posts published by *People's Daily* on Weibo and compared them with its print editions to examine differences in environmental reporting across platforms.

Human-Machine Co-creation in AI-Empowered Silk Road Cultural Narratives

Research Assistant | PI: Xinxin Li, Lanzhou University Mar. 2025 - May. 2025

- Compiled and organized narrative materials on the historical development of the Silk Road.
- Synthesized research trends in Silk Road studies across multiple social science disciplines and developed them into a comprehensive literature review.

Lanzhou Bathing Assistant: Seeing Aging at Mobile Bathhouses

Field Research | Advisor: Shiping, Lanzhou University Aug. 2024 - Jan. 2025 [🌐]

- Conducted ethnographic fieldwork on Lanzhou's emerging in-home elder-bathing industry, examining bodily dignity and social invisibility among disabled and bedridden older adults under China's home-based eldercare model.
- Combined participant observation with semi-structured interviews involving the company founder, bathing assistants, eldercare-center managers, and family caregivers. Analyzed how demographic change, local climate, economic conditions, bathing culture, and attitudes toward aging shaped the industry's development in northwest China. Produced an in-depth research report and short video documentary.

Why Do College Students Have a Particular Affinity for Life "Within the System"?

Student Research | Advisor: Zhangchi, Lanzhou University Apr. 2024 - Apr. 2025

- Investigated Chinese college students' growing preference for public-sector employment through survey research. Contributed to questionnaire design, data collection, and statistical analysis to identify key predictors of career choices.
- Conducted semi-structured interviews to complement survey findings, exploring the motivations behind young Chinese people's preference for civil-service positions and developing evidence-based policy recommendations.

SELECTED AWARDS AND HONORS

- **China Data Journalism Competition**, Second Prize [🌐] Nov. 2025
- **China Statistical Modeling Competition, Lanzhou University Campus Round**, Second Prize [🌐] May. 2026
- **Central China Mathematical Modeling Competition**, Second Prize [🌐] May. 2026
- **China University Campus Media Competition**, Public Service Communication Award [🌐] Nov. 2025
- **14th China Tower Journalists' Day**, Grand Prize in the Communications Category [🌐] Dec. 2025
- **Lanzhou University Outstanding Student Scholarship** [🌐] Sep. 2023 - Sep. 2024

SKILLS

- **Programming:** R, Python, Web Development (HTML, CSS), AI4SS
- **Quantitative Methods:** Fundamentals of probability and statistics, Regression, ANOVA
- **Computational Methods:** NLP, Automated content analysis, Topic modeling, Machine learning, Images-as-data
- **Qualitative Methods:** Interviews, Coding, Content analysis, Field research
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (TOEFL iBT: 5.0/6.0 (equivalent to 100/120; CEFR C1))
- **Production Tools:** LaTeX, Microsoft Office Suite, Photography